Project Continuity Summary

National Retail Company: Business Intelligence & Interactive Dashboard Development

Dataset: SampleSuperstore Kaggle

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The Dataset Used

For my week 3 analysis, I will be using Sample Superstore dataset from Kaggle that contains 9995 rows and 21 fields. This dataset has approximately 2.30M in total sales and $286.40k in total profit across 4 regions, 3 categories and 3 customer segments from 2014 to 2016. Key metrics tracked include sales, profit, discount, shipping mode, product category and customer segment.

Business Problem

The business is overall profitable with margin of 12.47% but profitability is inconsistent. The main problem is that high sales do not always translate to high profitability, and performance is based on category, region, sub-category, shipping mode, time of the year and discount. Management needs to understand key drivers of profitability and sales, to develop effective strategies to stabilize the market and allocate resources to the right areas

Key Findings

- West region is the top performer with $108.42k profit. South region sis the lowest at $46.75k
- Consumer segment accounts for the majority of orders and sales. Home segment is the lowest performing
- Products with low discounts have high sales
- Sales peak in the last month of the quarter and profitability peaks in Q4, specifically December
- Standard class is the dominant and most profitable shipping mode. Same day shipping has the lowest performance
- Technology leads in both sales & profitability. Phomes drive the most sales and copiers generate the highest profit margins. With furniture being the least profitable category

Key Insight: Profitability does not always follow sales volume. Office supplies is more profitable than furniture despite lower sales

Areas to Investigate Further

- What factors are driving the profit fluctuations across months and quarters?
- Why is Q4 / December consistently the most profitable period - is it demand, pricing, or cost?
- What causes the disconnect between sales and profit - e.g. why is Office Supplies more profitable than Furniture?

- Why is the Home customer segment underperforming compared to Consumer?
- Why is Same-Day shipping underperforming despite being more efficient?
- What factors make the west region outperform, and how can those be applied to the south region